



A PRACTICAL POCKET GUIDE

1ST
EDITION
2026

CLINICAL CORRELATION OF LABORATORY FINDINGS

A Practical Pocket Guide for
Medical Laboratory Professionals
and Clinicians



PATTERN-BASED
INTERPRETATION



THINK OF



PATTERN
HELPS



CHECK
NEXT



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Quality Control Expert



Accurate Interpretation • Clinical Insight • Better Outcomes

Clinical Correlation of Laboratory Findings

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Professionals and Clinicians**

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Reference-Range Note

Reference intervals and decision limits vary according to laboratory, analyzer, method, age, sex, pregnancy status, altitude, and population. Always use the validated reference interval, critical-value policy, and interpretive guidance of the reporting laboratory.

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About the Author



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Mr Shankar Shahi is a Senior Medical Laboratory Technologist and Quality Control Expert with more than 20 years of experience in the medical laboratory field and more than 5 years of focused experience in Quality Control and Quality Management Systems. His professional interests include clinical laboratory interpretation, internal quality control, external quality assessment, method verification, laboratory standardization, SOP development, staff training, and practical implementation of quality systems in diagnostic laboratories. This pocket guide reflects a practical approach to translating laboratory findings into clinically meaningful patterns.

Dedicated to quality, committed to care.

Preface

Laboratory results become most valuable when they are interpreted in context rather than read as isolated numbers. This book is designed as a practical bridge between analytical laboratory work and clinical decision-making. It emphasizes specimen quality, analytical validity, reference intervals, decision limits, pattern recognition, supportive testing, critical-result awareness, and correlation with patient history.

The central approach of this pocket guide is simple: begin with the laboratory finding, **think of** the important possibilities, use the surrounding results to see how the **pattern helps**, and decide what to **check next**. The purpose is not to replace clinical diagnosis, but to help laboratory professionals and clinicians recognize meaningful laboratory patterns quickly and logically.

The intended readers include medical laboratory technologists, technicians, students, clinicians, nurses, and laboratory managers. I hope this guide serves as a practical companion at the laboratory bench, in training, and during day-to-day clinical correlation.

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How to Use This Pocket Guide

Start with the abnormal laboratory finding and first confirm the reference range and unit. Consider the important causes of increase or decrease, then look at the surrounding results to identify the pattern. Correlate the pattern with the clinical context and decide what to check next.

Use the High-Yield Points for rapid review. “Think of” and “Pattern Helps” are diagnostic clues, not stand-alone diagnoses. Always follow the reporting laboratory’s validated reference interval, critical-value policy and guidance.

- 1 Find the abnormal result
- 2 Recognize the pattern
- 3 Check the next test

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